Himaayah Schools
TEENAGERS BUILDING CIRCLE

GUIDE

الْمَرْءُ عَلَى دِينِ خَلِيلِهِ فَلْيَنْظُرْ أَحَدُكُمْ مَنْ يُخَالِلُ

"A person is on the way of his close friend, so let each of you look at whom he befriends." (Abū Dāwūd 4833, at-Tirmidhī 2378)

Month 7

Friends and Influence

Choose well, stand firm, forgive and be a good friend. A guide for students for each live session this month.

بِسْمِ اللَّهِ الرَّحْمٰنِ الرَّحِيمِ

Month 7: Friends and Influence

Your friends shape you more than you realise. This month you learn to choose them wisely, hold your ground under pressure, mend what breaks, and be the kind of friend others need.

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How to use this guide

1. **Before each session**, read that session’s short teaching below. It takes two minutes.
2. **During the session**, take notes on the lines provided and write one question to ask.
3. **After the session**, do the “Try it” action within two days.
4. **Every day**, tick your habit tracker. **Every Sunday**, spend five minutes reviewing the week.
5. **At the end of the month**, complete the Month Review and show it to a parent or your facilitator.

This month at a glance

Week	Deen	Educational Development	Skills	Personal Development
Week 1 Choosing friends	The perfumer and the blacksmith	Study groups that work	Active listening	What makes a good friend
Week 2 Standing firm	Ḥayāʾ: modesty	Fair work in groups	Saying no, firmly and kindly	Know your values
Week 3 Conflict and forgiveness	Forgiving for Allah's sake	Disagreeing respectfully	Apologising well	Healthy boundaries
Week 4 Being a good friend	Love for your brother	Peer tutoring	Encourage and give feedback	Loyal and honest together

The month's challenge

Do one deliberate kindness for a friend every day for seven days, and forgive one person.

Week 1 Choosing friends

Deen: The perfumer and the blacksmith

The Prophet ﷺ compared a good companion to a perfume seller: you may buy from him, receive a gift, or at least smell something pleasant. A bad companion is like a blacksmith: you may be burned or smell smoke (al-Bukhārī 2101, Muslim 2628).

Try it this week

List your closest five friends. For each, write whether they make you better or worse in deen and effort.

My notes and questions

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Educational Development: Study groups that work

A good study group is small, meets at a fixed time, has a clear goal and gives everyone a turn to explain.

Try it this week

Invite two classmates to a 30-minute study session with an agenda and a time limit.

My notes and questions

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Week 1: Choosing friends (continued)

Skills: Active listening

Active listening means eye contact, no phone, short nods and one question to show you understood.

Try it this week

Practise active listening for five minutes with a friend and ask them how it felt.

My notes and questions

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Personal Development: What makes a good friend

A good friend is honest, loyal, kind and reminds you of Allah. Be that person first.

Try it this week

Write five qualities you want in a friend and score yourself honestly on each.

My notes and questions

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Week 2 Standing firm

Deen: Ḥayāʾ: modesty

The Prophet ﷺ said modesty is part of faith (al-Bukhārī 9, Muslim 35). It helps you refuse what is wrong without a speech.

Try it this week

Think of one situation where you feel pressure to do wrong and plan what you will say.

My notes and questions

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Educational Development: Fair work in groups

In group work, agree on roles early, write who does what and by when, and check progress halfway.

Try it this week

In your next group task, write down roles and deadlines before anyone starts.

My notes and questions

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Week 2: Standing firm (continued)

Skills: Saying no, firmly and kindly

A good refusal is short, calm and repeated if needed: “No thanks, that’s not for me.” You do not owe a long explanation.

Try it this week

Practise three different ways to say no with a family member.

My notes and questions

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Personal Development: Know your values

Pressure is easier to resist when you have decided in advance what you stand for. Write your values down.

Try it this week

Write your top five values and one action for each that shows you live by it.

My notes and questions

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Week 3 Conflict and forgiveness

Deen: Forgiving for Allah's sake

Allah says, "Let them pardon and overlook. Would you not like Allah to forgive you?" (an-Nūr 24:22). Forgiveness frees you more than the one forgiven.

Try it this week

Forgive one person who wronged you and make du'ā for them.

My notes and questions

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Educational Development: Disagreeing respectfully

In discussion, attack the idea, not the person. Say what you agree with first and then explain your difference.

Try it this week

In your next discussion, begin your reply with "I agree that … and I see it differently on …".

My notes and questions

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Skills: Apologising well

A good apology names what you did, says sorry without “but”, and offers to put it right.

Try it this week

Write the apology you owe to someone, or deliver one in person this week.

My notes and questions

Personal Development: Healthy boundaries

Boundaries are the limits that protect your time, deen and peace. Setting them is not unkind.

Try it this week

Name one boundary you need and how you will say it politely.

My notes and questions

Week 4 Being a good friend

Deen: Love for your brother

The Prophet ﷺ said none of you truly believes until he loves for his brother what he loves for himself (al-Bukhārī 13, Muslim 45).

Try it this week

Do one thing for a friend this week that you would want done for you, and do not mention it.

My notes and questions

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Educational Development: Peer tutoring

Helping a classmate with a subject you know well deepens your own understanding.

Try it this week

Offer to explain one topic to a classmate for 20 minutes.

My notes and questions

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Week 4: Being a good friend (continued)

Skills: Encourage and give feedback

Good feedback is specific, kind and useful. Start with what is working, then say one thing to improve.

Try it this week

Give a friend specific, kind feedback on something they made or did.

My notes and questions

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Personal Development: Loyal and honest together

Real loyalty includes honesty. A friend who only agrees with you is not helping.

Try it this week

Think of a time you stayed silent when you should have advised. Plan how to do it better next time.

My notes and questions

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Daily habit tracker

Tick each box when you have done it. Be honest: the tracker is for you.

Week 1

Habit	Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri	Sat	Sun
Five prayers on time	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Qur'an portion	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
25-minute study block	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Screen-free hour	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
This month's "Try it"	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

Week 2

Habit	Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri	Sat	Sun
Five prayers on time	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Qur'an portion	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
25-minute study block	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Screen-free hour	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
This month's "Try it"	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

Week 3

Habit	Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri	Sat	Sun
Five prayers on time	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Qur'an portion	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
25-minute study block	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Screen-free hour	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
This month's "Try it"	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

Week 4

Habit	Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri	Sat	Sun
Five prayers on time	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Qur'an portion	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
25-minute study block	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Screen-free hour	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
This month's "Try it"	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

Month review

Rate yourself honestly from 1 (needs support) to 5 (excelling), then write one win and one thing to improve.

Pillar	Rating (circle one)	One thing I did well	One thing to improve
Deen	1 2 3 4 5		
Educational Development	1 2 3 4 5		
Skills	1 2 3 4 5		
Personal Development	1 2 3 4 5		

My biggest win this month

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What was hardest, and why

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What I will do next month

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Facilitator's comment

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Parent's comment

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A page for parents

Get to know your teenager's friends and welcome them at home. Talk about what makes a good friend without criticising the ones they have, and help them find friends who share good values.

- **What the monthly report shows.** Your teenager's facilitator sends a report each month with attendance, a rating for each of the four pillars, assignments handed in and a personal note.
- **Three questions to ask this month.** What did you learn that surprised you? Which session helped you most, and why? What is one thing I can do to support you?
- **How to help.** A calm place and time to study, early nights, and your interest. Praise effort and honesty more than marks.

رَبَّنَا هَبْ لَنَا مِنْ أَزْوَاجِنَا وَذُرِّيَّاتِنَا قُرَّةَ أَعْيُنٍ وَاجْعَلْنَا لِلْمُتَّقِينَ إِمَامًا

"Our Lord, grant us from our spouses and offspring comfort to our eyes and make us a leader for the righteous."

Al-Furqān 25:74

Next month

Month 8: Body, Mind and Rest. Sleep, movement, calm and balance.

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Four sessions a week, one clear focus.

Your friends shape you more than you realise. This month you learn to choose them wisely, hold your ground under pressure, mend what breaks, and be the kind of friend others need.

- Week 1: Choosing friends
- Week 2: Standing firm
- Week 3: Conflict and forgiveness
- Week 4: Being a good friend
- A habit tracker, a month review and a page for parents

Join the Teenagers Building Circle

Deen, education, skills and personal development, live four times a week for ages 13 to 19.

himaayahschools.com/teenagers-building-circle